Indira Rajaraman read through every chapter and Anantha Nageswaran through most chapters. I profited immensely from their insightful feedback and suggestions, and was deeply touched by their generosity, patience and enthusiasm. I owe them more than they realize.

At the Reserve Bank, Janak Raj and Muneesh Kapur peer-reviewed several chapters with the same diligence and critical eye as they would have were I still the serving governor. I was deeply touched by their earnestness and enthusiasm. Others at RBI, serving and retired, who provided me thoughtful inputs or reviewed one or more chapters were, in alphabetical order: Vivek Aggarwal, S.K. Bal, Surajit Bose, Madhumita Deb, Suddhasattwa Ghosh, Meena Hemachandra, Gunjeet Kaur, Grace Koshie, G. Mahalingam, A.K. Misra, Deepak Mohanty, Gopalraman Padmanabhan, Suman Ray, Mridul Saggar, Uma Shankar and Susobhan Sinha. Being thoroughbred Reserve Bank professionals, they did not endorse all of what I said or the way I said it. My apologies to all those who I may have inadvertently missed out, and my sincere thanks to them as well as to all those who helped from behind the scenes.

I felt free to use retired deputy governors of RBI—Shyamala Gopinath, Usha Thorat, Subir Gokarn and Anand Sinha—as my sounding board on a number of issues, and they indulged me as before with their wise counsel and advice. It felt very nostalgic.

Outside the Reserve Bank, those who reviewed one or more chapters and gave constructive feedback were, again in alphabetical order: Gita Bhat, Mythili Bhusnurmath, Kalpana Kochhar, K.P. Krishnan, Amitendu Palit, V.G.S. Rajan, Alok Sheel, Venky Venkatesan and Jumana Zahalka. My thanks to Rinisha Dutt for her research assistance.

The improvement from my first drafts to the final versions that you see owes to the comments and contributions of all the above reviewers. The standard caveat that I remain responsible for the final version applies.

I am grateful to the team at Penguin—Meru Gokhale, Ranjana Sengupta, V.C. Shanuj and Anushree Kaushal, and indeed all their teammates—for leading me through the mysterious realm of book publishing with passion and professionalism.